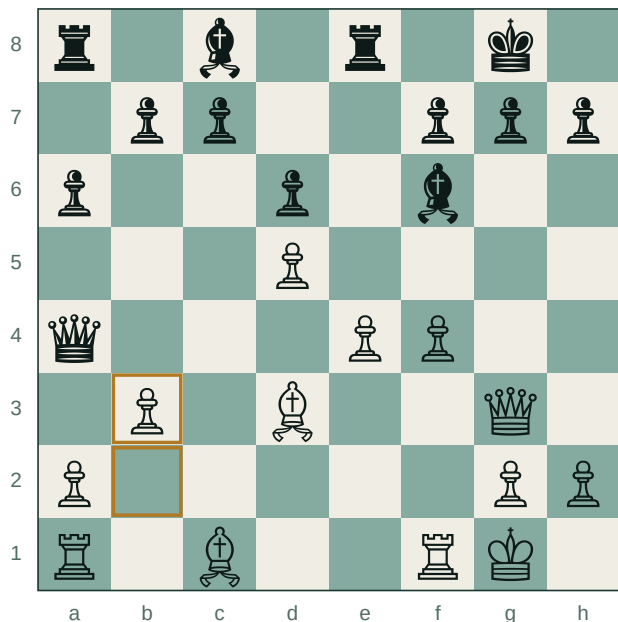


Interference tactics: Black, move 15

Interference tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 15.b3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Qd4+ 16. Be3 Qxd3

15...Qd4+ Check restricts White to 5 legal replies here. From d4 it attacks king on g1, rook on a1 and bishop on d3. Recorded reply: **16.Be3**.

16...Qxd3 The queen captures the bishop on d3. From d3 it attacks rook on f1 and bishop on e3.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Capturing the interposing piece may restore defense. Calculate which captures are legal and whether they permit another tactic.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Interference interrupts a defensive line between enemy pieces. Occupying one square can make a previously protected target vulnerable or prevent an important recapture.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the defender's line to its target and inspect forcing moves onto the intervening squares.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: rook on a1. Check for tactical protection.